Lab 09 — Measure value and make an investment case

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Microsoft tool focus: Copilot in Excel and Word

All Northstar Service names, policies and values are synthetic training material. They are not a claim about a real company or a Microsoft tenant.

Executive outcome

Complete five short, source-backed business tasks for measure value and make an investment case. Each task must show a source, human owner, uncertainty, test, measurable result and go/hold/revise gate.

Materials in this folder

- source-pack.md — fictional organisation context, policy and five case facts.
- scenario.csv — five decisions, expected outputs and challenge checks.
- prompt-cards.md — copy-ready prompts for each case.
- executive-brief.docx — editable briefing input.
- value-model.csv and value-model.xlsx — synthetic business values and formulas.
- evidence-template.md — decision record to copy for each case.
- workflow-reference.png — official Microsoft Support app example for orientation; workflow and agent screens can differ.

Steps

1. Read BRD-1 to BRD-4 in source-pack.md and identify which rule applies to your case.
2. Open scenario.csv and select one case ID. Note its intended decision, named output, challenge and outcome measure.
3. Use Copilot in Excel to explain the synthetic value model. Check formulas and quality before writing an investment note.
4. Copy the matching prompt from prompt-cards.md. Provide only the synthetic source content. Ask Copilot for a first draft, cited facts, assumptions and counterargument. For Workflows, specify trigger, action, approval and exception. For Agent Builder, specify purpose, instructions, approved knowledge and test cases.
5. Compare each material statement and number with source-pack.md or value-model.xlsx. Correct or remove unsupported claims. Recalculate net minutes: baseline minus Copilot time minus human review time.
6. Record the decision in a copy of evidence-template.md. State the source, evidence, owner, date, outcome measure and go/hold/revise conclusion.
7. Repeat steps 2–6 for the other four case IDs. Submit all five reviewed task records and the workflow or agent design when relevant.

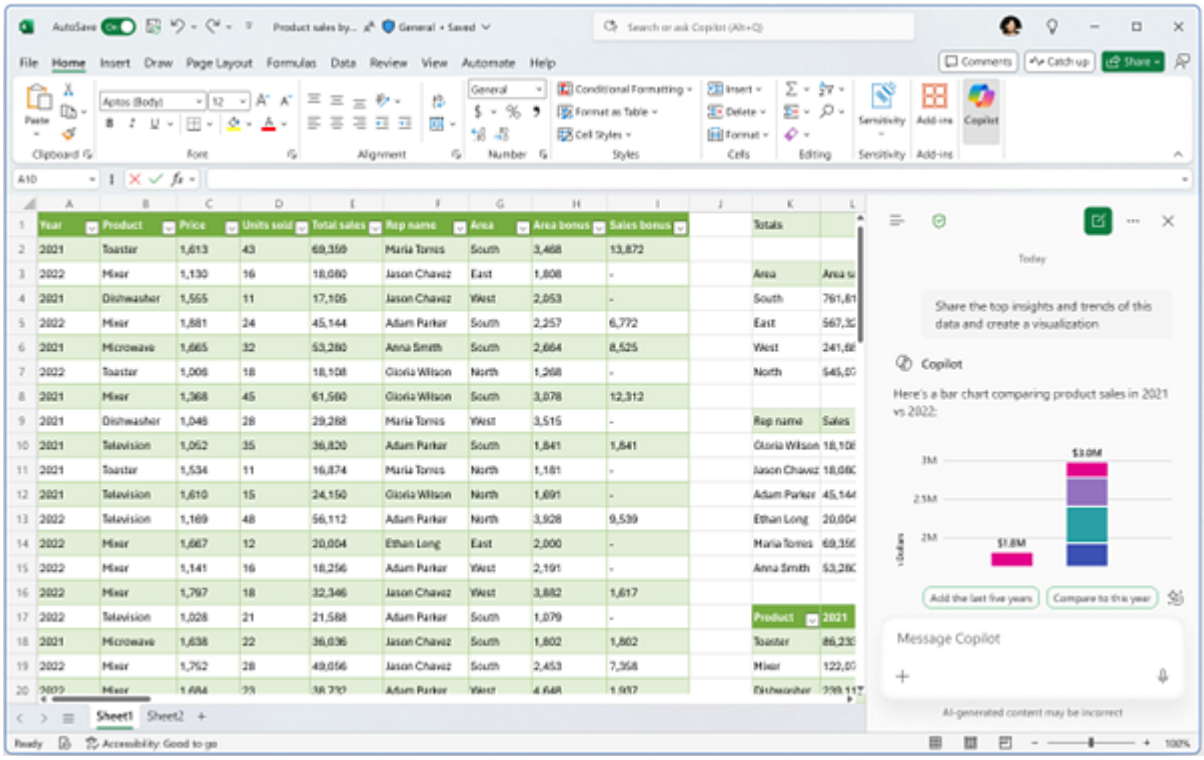
Acceptance checks

- Five case IDs have five reviewed decision records.
- Every claim or value used to justify a decision cites the supplied source.
- Every record states the strongest challenge or failed test and how it was resolved.
- Any monetary value is labelled as a synthetic assumption, not measured savings.
- The human owner approves external commitments and high-impact decisions.
- The output says “offline simulation” when the live Copilot feature was unavailable.

Troubleshooting

If Copilot cannot see the source, check your work account and licensing with the trainer. Continue with the local files and mark the work offline. If Copilot invents a figure, remove it and ask for a source-based revision. If two sources conflict, hold the decision and name the owner who will resolve the conflict.

UI reference



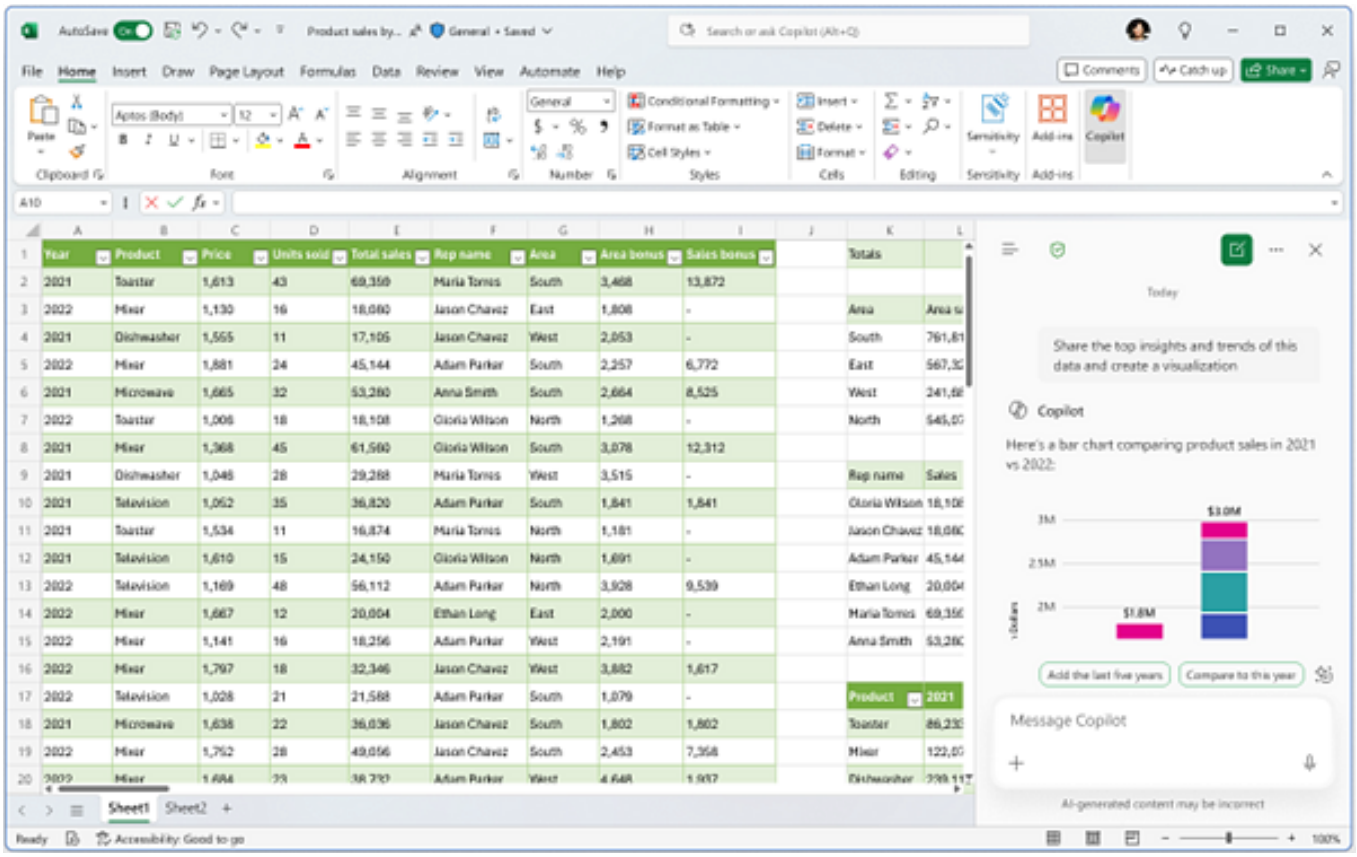
Source: https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/how-copilot-chat-works-in-microsoft-365-apps. Interface and licensing may differ in your tenant. Do not submit this image as your own result.

Microsoft product references

- https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/get-started-writing-prompts-in-microsoft-365-copilot
- https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/copilot-controls/security-governance
- https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/get-started-with-workflows-in-microsoft-365-copilot
- https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/build-your-own-agent-with-microsoft-365-copilot

Workflow reference screenshot

Official Microsoft Support example for orientation; not evidence of your lab result.



Screenshot source: https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/how-copilot-chat-works-in-microsoft-365-apps
The Microsoft interface and available controls may differ in your work account.